सत्यमेव जयते

भारत सरकार/Government of India

गृह मंत्रालय/Ministry of Home Affairs

भारत के महारजिस्ट्रार एवं जनगणना आयुक्त का कार्यालय

Office of the Registrar General & Census Commissioner, India

जनगणना प्रभाग/Census Division

No. 9/26/2018-CD **Dated: 14th August, 2025**

Census of India 2027- Circular No. 2

Subject: Rural- Urban Classification for Census 2027.

As the preparatory work for Census 2027, the first and foremost task to be handled by Directorates of Census Operations is the demarcation of rural and urban areas.

2. The first step in this direction, by preparing an updated list of villages and towns/wards after incorporating the jurisdictional changes that have taken place after Census 2011 and up to 31.12.2025 has already been communicated vide Circular No.1 dated 13.08.2025. The next step is to identify the Census Towns by applying the urban criteria to all villages including the Census Towns and Out Growths of Census 2011. The definition of an urban unit at the Census 2011 was as follows:

(a) All administrative units that have been defined by statute as urban like Municipal Corporation, Municipality, Cantonment Board, Notified Town Area Committee, Town Panchayat, Nagar Palika etc. are known as Statutory Towns. Further, Statutory Towns with population of 1,00,000 and above are categorized as cities.

(b) All other villages which satisfied the following criteria:

(i) A minimum population of 5,000 persons;

(ii) 75 percent and above of the male main working population being engaged in non-agricultural pursuits; and;

(iii) A density of population of at least 400 persons per sq. km. (1,000 per sq. mile).

3. It is proposed to retain the same definition for urban areas for Census 2027, as this will ensure comparability with previous Census and provide the basis for analysis of urbanization trends in the country. For the purpose of preparing the Rural- Urban frame for Census 2027, the civic status of the places referred to in (a) of the urban unit definition is as on 01.01.2026 (i.e. the date on which all the administrative boundaries will be frozen). For other units referred to in (b) of the urban unit definition, the fulfillment of criteria i.e. minimum 5,000 population is the expected population at Census 2027 and the other two criteria of male main workers and density of population are as per Census 2011.

4. For the purpose of identification of urban units based on the demographic criteria as at (b) in para 2 (i.e., population size and proportion of workers), like in the previous censuses, all villages having a population of 4,000 or more at the preceding Census 2011 are required to be taken up for examination because a village having a population of 4,000 or more in Census 2011 is expected to cross the population mark of 5,000 persons by Census 2027. For such cases, the composition of work force and the density of population are required to be examined to see whether these qualify to be categorised as urban. While applying the test of main working population engaged in non-agricultural pursuits, male main workers will be considered and the workers engaged in the agricultural activities, namely (a) Cultivators, (b) Agricultural Laborers and (c) Plantation, Livestock, Forestry, Fishing, Hunting and allied activities are to be excluded from the total male main workers for computing the percentage of male main workers engaged in non-agricultural pursuits.

5. All units which have been notified under law and have local bodies like municipal corporations, municipalities, municipal committees, municipal boards, municipal town committees, cantonment boards, notified areas, notified area committees, town committees, town areas, town boards, town municipalities, sanitary boards, Nagar Panchayats, etc., irrespective of their demographic characteristics, must be included in the list of towns. It is to be noted that for this category of towns the criteria laid down in para 2(b) above will not be applicable.

6. A district/sub-division/tahsil headquarters, if not a statutory town, need to be treated as a census town only if it satisfies the demographic criteria mentioned in para 2(b) above.

7. Jurisdictional changes, if any, of the towns and villages after the last census should also be noted and notifications issued to this effect from time to time may be kept on record. An

exercise may also be carried out to see if villages recognized as urban (Census towns and Out Growths) in the Census 2011 satisfy the demographic criteria mentioned in para 2(b) above so as to be considered as independent census towns in Census 2027 as well. While doing this exercise, care should be taken in respect of those out growths which were formed by taking a part of a village in 2011. In such cases, the urban criteria should be applied to the whole village.

8. For identification of 75% male main workers engaged in non-agricultural pursuits, the data of other workers engaged in industrial category of livestock, forestry, fishing, hunting, plantation and orchards etc. was already provided to all DCOs during preparation for Census 2021 and accordingly all DCOs had already identified and finalized census towns as on 31.12.2019, for which approval from ORGI was also sent. Now, in view of the extension of jurisdictional changes upto 31.12.2025, some of these census towns might have been notified as statutory town or merged into statutory town. Further, during 2021, it was observed that, some of the DCOs were continuing the practice of classifying groups of villages as a single census town, even though the criteria for identifying a census town were meant to be applied at the individual village level. As per instructions from ORGI, this practice has to be discontinued and the frame to be prepared accordingly by taking into consideration individual village as a separate rural or urban unit.

9. After finalizing the urban units as mentioned in above paras, the requisite particulars are to be furnished in the enclosed proformae I.1, I.2, II.1 to II.6 as on 31.12.2025 as early as possible but not later than 15.01.2026 in soft (excel format) as well as hard copy.

10. The receipt of this circular may be acknowledged.

Narayanm 14/8/2025

(Mritunjay Kumar Narayan)

Encl: As above.

Registrar General & Census Commissioner, India

To

All Directorates of Census Operations.

Copy to:

1. All Divisional Heads of ORGI
2. PS to Addl. RG (S/SK) and PS to DDG.
3. Guard File.

Circular 2 Proforma - I.1

District- wise list of Villages/Census Towns which have been notified by the Govt. as new Statutory Towns after Census 2011

Name of State/Union Territory: **As on 31.12.2025**

S. No.	Name of Village/Census Town	Area In Sq.Km (Census 2011)	Propulation (Census 2011)	Name of Statutory Town	Sub- District		District		Remarks
					Name	MDDS Code (2011)	Name	MDDS Code (2011)	
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

Signature of the Controlling Officer

Circular 2 Proforma - I. 2

District- wise list of villages which qualify to be treated as new Census Towns for Census 2027

Name of State/Union Territory: **As on 31.12.2025**

S. No.	District		Sub-District		Village*		Area in Sq.Km (Census 2011)	Propulation (Census 2011)	Population Density (Per Sq. Km.)	Percentage of total male main workers in the categories of C, AL & allied activities**	Remarks
	Name	MDDS Code (2011)	Name	MDDS Code (2011)	Name	MDDS Code (2011)					
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12

* Only those villages may be included which had "Population of 4,000 and above; Population Density of at least 400 persons per sq.km; Less than 25 percent of the total male main working population engaged in agricultural pursuits as per Census 2011."

** Includes 1. Cultivators, 2. Agriculatural Labourers and 3. Plantation, Livestock, Forestry, Fishing, Hunting and allied activities.

Signature of the Controlling Officer

Circular 2 Proforma - II. 1

Statutory Towns (other than Census Towns) of Census 2011 which will continue in Census 2027								
Name of State/Union Territory:								As on 31.12.2025
S. No.	District		Sub-District*		Town		Civic Status	Remarks
	Name	MDDS Code (2011)	Name	MDDS Code (2011)	Name	MDDS Code (2011)		
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9

**** Mention name of Mandal /Circle /Taluk /Sub - Division/C.D. Block, whichever is applicable.***

Signature of the Controlling Officer

Circular 2 Proforma - II. 2

Census Towns of 2011 Census which will continute in Census 2027							
Name of State/Union Territory:						**As on 31.12.2025**	
S. No.	**Census Town**		**Census 2011 Data on parameters a, b & c ***	**District**		**Sub-District****	
	Name	**MDDS Code (2011)**		**Name**	**MDDS Code (2011)**	**Name**	**MDDS Code (2011)**
1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**	**6**	**7**	**8**
			a. b. c.				
			a. b. c.				
			a. b. c.				
			a. b. c.				
			a. b. c.				

a - Population; b - Density; c - Percentage of male main workers in categories 1. Cultivators, 2. Agricultural Labourers and 3. Plantation, Livestock, Forestry , Fishing, Hunting and allied activities.

***** Mention name of Mandal /Circle /Taluk /Sub - Division/C.D. Block, whichever is applicable.***

Signature of the Controlling Officer

Circular 2 Proforma - II. 3

Statutory Towns of Census 2011 but denotified later and do not satisfy the demographic criteria for identification as Census Towns for Census 2027

Name of State/Union Territory: **As on 31.12.2025**

S. No.	De-notified Town		Civic status as per Census 2011	Name of the village(s) formed after De-notification of Statutory Town	Census 2011 Data on parameters a, b, c,of the De-notified Statutory Town*	Sub-District**		District	
	Name	MDDS Code (2011)				Name	MDDS Code (2011)	Name	MDDS Code (2011)
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
					a. b. c.				
					a. b. c.				
					a. b. c.				
					a. b. c.				

** a - Population; b - Density; c - Percentage of male main workers in categories 1. Cultivators, 2. Agricultural Labourers and 3. Plantation, Livestock, Forestry, Fishing, Hunting and allied activities.*

*** Mention name of Mandal /Circle /Taluk /Sub - Division/C.D. Block, whichever is applicable.*

Signature of the Controlling Officer

Circular 2 Proforma - II. 4

Statutory Towns of Census 2011 de-notified later but satisfy the demographic criteria for identification as Census Towns for Census 2027									
Name of State/Union Territory:						As on 31.12.2025			
S. No.	De-notified Town		Civic status as per Census 2011	Name of the identified Census Town formed for Census 2027	Census 2011 Data on parameters a, b & c of the de-notified town*	Sub-District**		District	
	Name	MDDS Code (2011)				Name	MDDS Code (2011)	Name	MDDS Code (2011)
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
					a. b. c.				
					a. b. c.				
…					a. b. c.				
…					a. b. c.				

** a - Population; b - Density; c - Percentage of male main workers in categories 1. Cultivators, 2. Agricultural Labourers and 3. Plantation, Livestock, Forestry, Fishing, Hunting and allied activities.*

*** Mention name of Mandal /Circle /Taluk /Sub - Division/C.D. Block, whichever is applicable.*

Signature of the Controlling Officer

Circular 2 Proforma - II. 5

Census towns of Census 2011 which have subsequently lost the demographic criteria								
Name of State/Union Territory:							As on 31.12.2025	
S. No.	De-classified Census Town		Name of the village formed for Census 2027	Census 2011 Data on parameters a, b & c *	Sub-District**		District	
	Name	MDDS Code (2011)			Name	MDDS Code (2011)	Name	MDDS Code (2011)
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
				a. b. c.				
				a. b. c.				
				a. b. c.				
				a. b. c.				

** a - Population; b - Density; c - Percentage of male main workers in categories 1. Cultivators, 2. Agricultural Labourers and 3. Plantation, Livestock, Forestry, Fishing, Hunting and allied activities.*

*** Mention name of Mandal /Circle /Taluk /Sub - Division/C.D. Block, whichever is applicable.*

Signature of the Controlling Officer

Circular 2 Proforma - II. 6

Towns (Statutory & Census) of Census 2011 which have been merged wholly with another Statutory Town after Census 2011									
Name of State/Union Territory:									As on 31.12.2025
S. No.	Statutory Town for Census 2027 #		Town/s of Census 2011 merged in the Town mentioned in Col. 2		Civic status of the towns mentioned in col. 4 as per Census 2011	Sub-District*		District	
	Name	Civic Status	Name	Code		Name	MDDS Code (2011)	Name	MDDS Code (2011)
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

 # Specify the name of the town with which it is merged or name of the new town formed due to merger fo two or more towns.

** Mention name of Mandal /Circle /Taluk /Sub - Division/C.D. Block, whichever is applicable.*

Signature of the Controlling Officer